



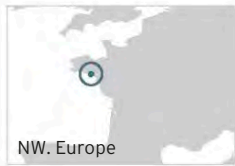
△ NEOLITHIC COMPLEX
Newgrange sits at the heart of the Neolithic Brú na Bóinne complex, which includes two similar passage tombs at nearby Dowth and Knowth and a further 90 monuments.



△ ENGRAVED KERBSTONE
The kerbstones that surround Newgrange are carved with a variety of curved and straight-line carvings. Their meaning is unknown, but they are thought to have some symbolic purpose.

Carnac Stones

Mysterious lines of prehistoric stones that continue to confound archaeologists



Striding across the open country around the Breton village of Carnac in western France are more than 4,000 standing stones—the largest assemblage of such stones in the world—erected by Neolithic people about 7,000 years ago, although some uncertainty surrounds their age.

The stones stretch in lines running northeast from Carnac and are arranged in three main alignments and one small alignment. The three main alignments of stones stand in converging rows or fanlike arrangements alongside prehistoric tombs (dolmens) and tumuli (mounds).



Mysterious lines
Quite why the stones were placed here is still a mystery. Some archaeologists have suggested alignments with sunsets at the solstices, or that the stones might have formed a huge observatory; others have proposed funerary uses or speculated that the stones mark a threshold between two different worlds. Local tradition says that the stones stand in straight lines because they were once a Roman legion turned to stone by the wizard Merlin.

△ RANKED BY HEIGHT
The standing stones vary in height from 2 ft (60 cm) to 13 ft (4 m), depending on their position along each alignment.

▽ MENÉC ALIGNMENT
The *Ménec* alignment consists of 12 converging rows of menhirs that stretch for 3,822 ft (1,165 m) and are roughly 328 ft (100 m) in width.



The **longest alignment**—the central *Kermario*—consists of **1,029 stones**